



MAKOLA.IO

Makola in Plain English

What this business is, what has been built, why it has not yet earned anything, and the few things that would change that.

31 August 2026

Written for someone new to it

No jargon

Every term explained where it appears

Eight pages

Pictures do most of the work

Prints in black and white

Nothing depends on colour

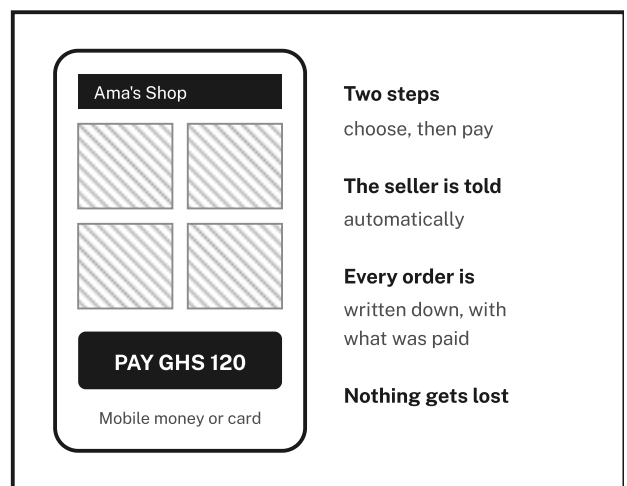
A shop, for people who are already selling in their messages

Across Ghana, thousands of people sell things from Instagram and WhatsApp. Clothes, shoes, hair products, food. They are running real businesses out of a chat window.

HOW IT WORKS TODAY



WITH A MAKOLA SHOP



The dashed box is what sellers do now. The solid box is what Makola replaces it with. The seller shares one link instead of answering the same questions all day.

WHAT THE SELLER GETS

A shop page with their own name on it. A link to put in their Instagram profile. A message every time someone orders. A list of what has been sold, paid for and delivered. It costs nothing to open.

HOW MAKOLA IS MEANT TO EARN

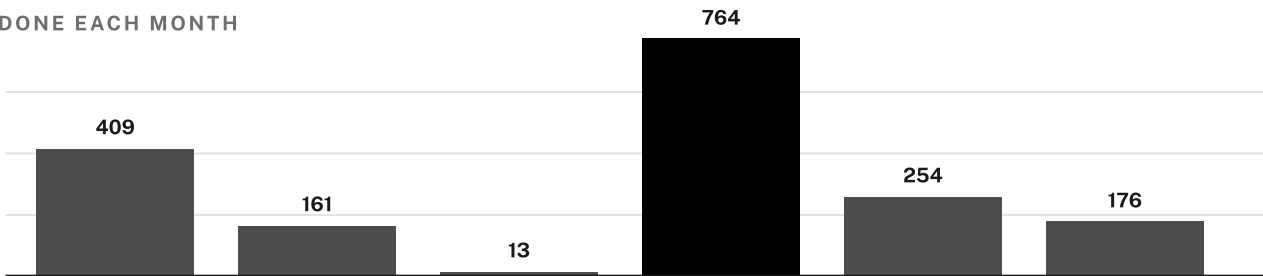
When something sells, Makola keeps a small part of the price and the seller gets the rest. If the seller sells nothing, they pay nothing. There is no monthly charge. That is the whole idea.

The building is finished. The selling has not started.

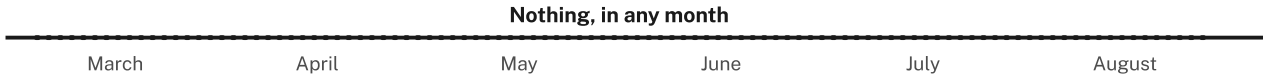
One person spent five months building this. It works. Nobody has been asked to use it.

185,000 Lines of software written	7,174 Automatic checks that run on every change	5 Sellers who signed up without being asked	0 Cedis Makola has ever earned
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WORK DONE EACH MONTH



MONEY EARNED EACH MONTH



June is the tallest bar because that is when the money side was finished. Everything after June added more features to software that already worked. The lower line has never left the floor.

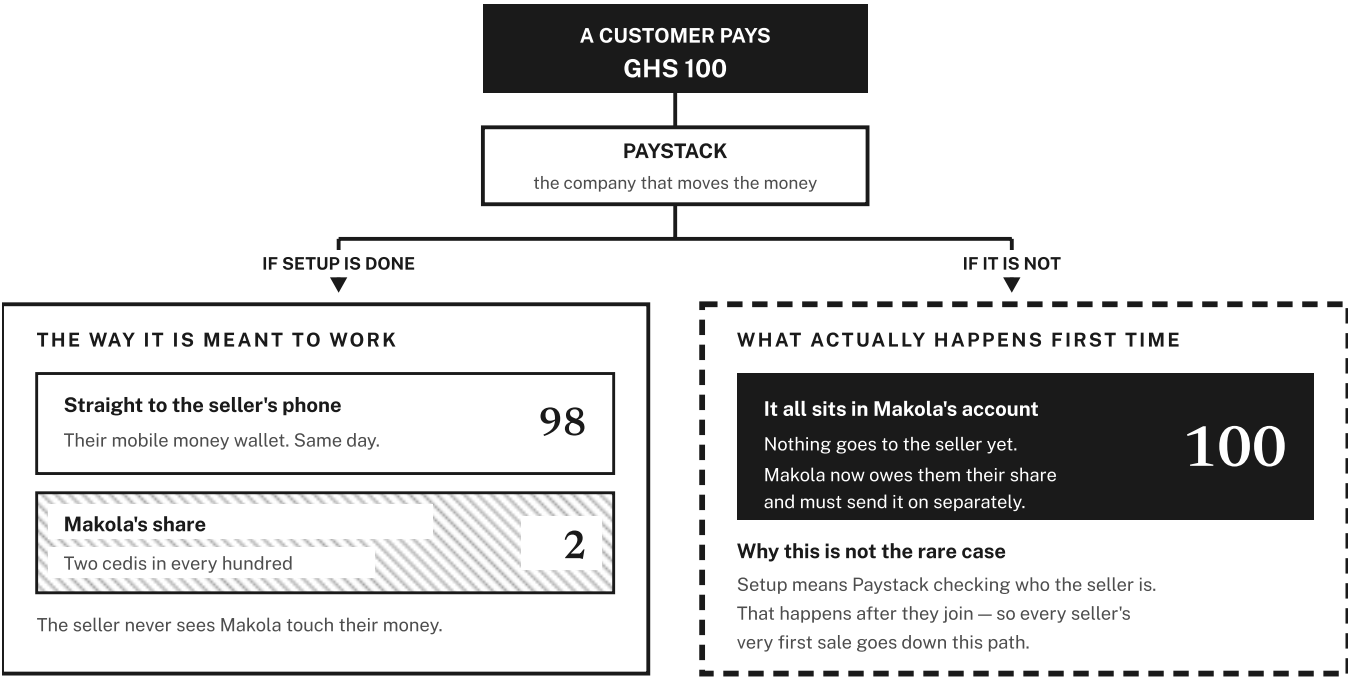
THE HONEST SUMMARY

The hard part — making the thing work — is done. The part nobody has started is walking up to a seller and asking them to try it. That is not a software problem, and no amount of further building will solve it.

One test purchase has been made using practice details that move no real money. Five sellers found the site and signed up on their own. Nobody has been approached, and no customer has ever paid a Ghanaian seller real money through Makola. **FROM PROJECT NOTES**

When a customer pays, the money takes a detour

Makola does not move money itself. A company called **Paystack** does that — it is the service that takes card and mobile-money payments on behalf of businesses. Every cedi passes through them first.



Holding someone else's money, even briefly, is the subject of page five.
It is the single largest unanswered question in the business.

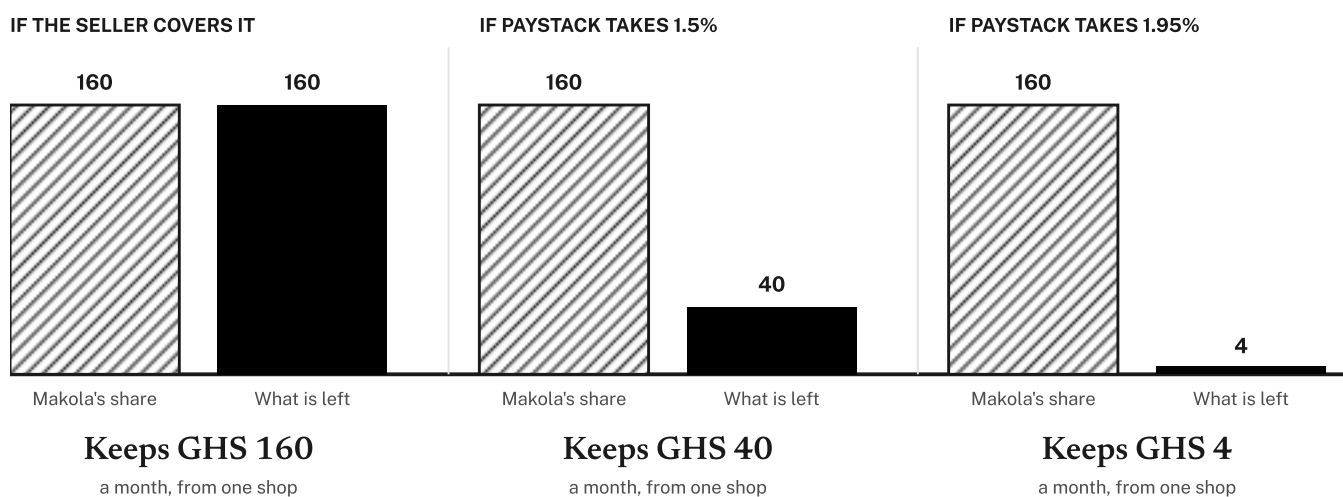
The solid box on the left is the design. The dashed box on the right is the reality on day one. Both are already built into the software — this is not a fault, it is how it was written.

Makola keeps two cedis, then pays Paystack out of them

Paystack charges for its work. Somebody has to cover that charge. At the moment it comes out of Makola's two cedis — not the seller's ninety-eight.

Nobody has yet asked Paystack what it charges in Ghana. That single unanswered question decides whether this business earns a reasonable amount per shop or almost nothing at all.

WHAT MAKOLA KEEPS FROM A SHOP SELLING GHS 8,000 A MONTH



The striped bar is the same in all three: two cedis in every hundred. The solid bar is what survives after Paystack is paid. The third case is not a disaster scenario — it is roughly what such services commonly charge.

THE CHARGE IS AN ESTIMATE — IT HAS NOT BEEN CONFIRMED

WHAT THIS MEANS IN SHOPS

To earn GHS 10,000 a month, Makola would need **63 shops** in the first case — or **2,500** in the third. The difference between a small business and an impossible one is a setting nobody has looked at.

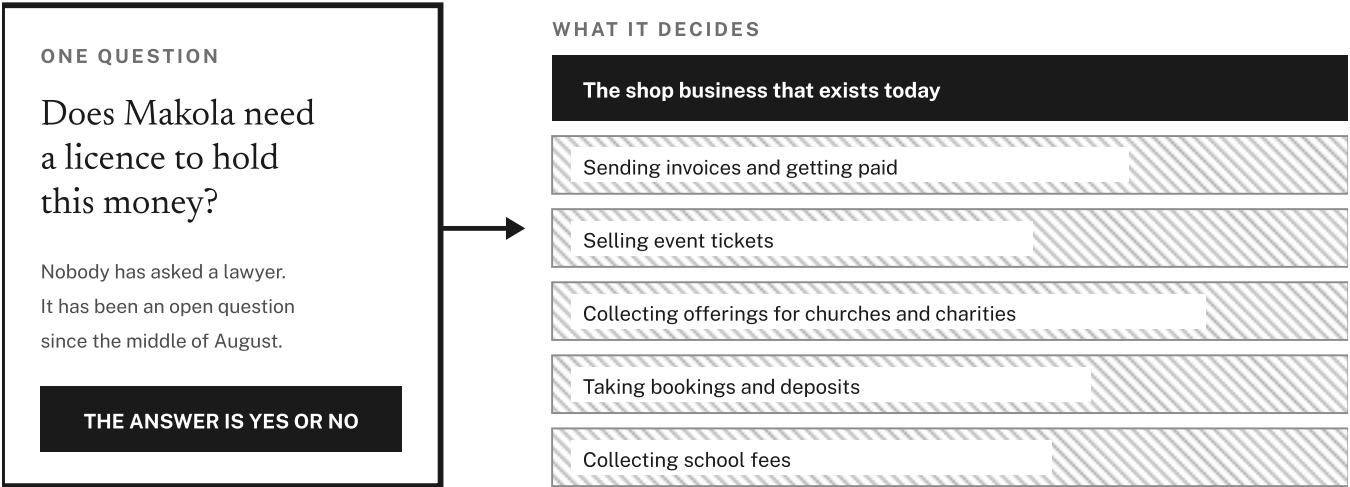
THE GOOD NEWS

Changing this is not a rebuild. The amount Makola keeps is a single setting, and it has never actually been chosen — the two-cedi figure is just what the software falls back on when nobody sets it. Raising it is one line, deployed the same way as any other change.

Holding other people's money needs permission

In Ghana, a business that holds money belonging to other people is doing something the law treats seriously. It requires a licence, and licences require money in the bank to back them.

As page three showed, Makola's software already holds money. On a seller's first sale, the whole payment sits in Makola's account before being passed on. That is not a plan for the future. It is what happens today.



The same money system underneath could run any of these businesses. They all hold money the same way, so one answer settles all of them at once — in either direction.

WHY IT IS WORTH DOING NOW RATHER THAN LATER

Right now the accounts are empty, so if the answer is unwelcome, nothing has to be unwound. Once real sellers' money is sitting there, discovering the same answer is a far harder position to be in. Asking costs one conversation with a Ghanaian lawyer who knows this area.

Four problems, none of them large

None of these is a rebuild. Three take about an hour each. They are listed in the order they matter.

	A seller's identity document can be opened by anyone	FIX FIRST
	One seller uploaded proof of who they are. That file can currently be opened by anybody who has the web address — no password needed. It has been like this since at least the end of August. This is somebody's real document, and it must be closed before another seller is invited to upload one.	
	Messages to sellers have never worked	BLOCKED OUTSIDE
	The promise is that a seller gets told the moment an order arrives, by WhatsApp or text. Neither has ever delivered a single message, because the accounts were never finished with WhatsApp's owners. The software reports success either way, so nobody noticed. For nineteen days, emails silently failed the same way.	
	The website offers two paid plans that cannot be charged for	ONE HOUR
	There are three plans on the pricing page. Two of them cost money each month, and there is no way to take that money — that part was built for a payment company that does not operate in Ghana. The prices themselves, 29 and 79, were copied from a template where they were dollars. Nobody chose them for Ghana.	
	The payment system is still in practice mode	ONE HOUR
	Makola is connected to Paystack using practice details. Real money cannot pass through until real ones are put in. Everything downstream of this — the fee, the payouts, the first cedi earned — waits on it.	

Filled square with a cross means it is causing harm right now, or blocking everything behind it.

Hollow square with a line means it is wrong but not yet hurting anyone, and quick to put right.

Stop building. Start asking people to use it.

In order. The first four take a day between them. The fifth is the one that has been put off for five months, and it is the only one that can produce money.

- 1 Close the open document**
Make the seller's identity file private, then check from a browser that a stranger genuinely cannot open it. Do this before anyone else is invited to join.
ABOUT AN HOUR

 - 2 Ask Paystack what they charge**
One email. The answer decides how much Makola keeps from every sale, and therefore whether it needs sixty shops or two thousand.
ONE EMAIL, THEN ONE SETTING CHANGED

 - 3 Ask a lawyer about holding the money**
This takes the longest to come back, so start it first. Until it is answered, nobody knows whether the business as built is allowed to operate as it does.
START NOW, ANSWER IN WEEKS

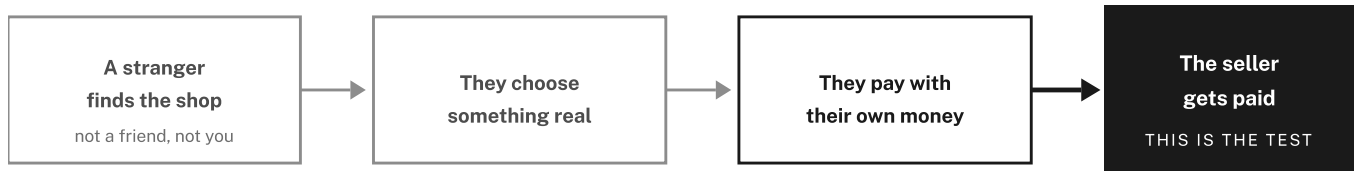
 - 4 Make the pricing page tell the truth**
Remove the two plans that cannot be charged for. Show one free option with the real percentage on it. Nobody has ever bought a paid plan, so nothing is lost.
ABOUT AN HOUR

 - 5 Turn on real payments and make one real sale**
Put in the real Paystack details. Then buy something, from a real shop, with real money, and watch it arrive in the seller's wallet. Until that has been seen happen once, nothing else is proven.
A DAY

 - 6 Ask sellers to join, one at a time**
Message ten to fifteen Instagram sellers a day for two weeks. Around a hundred and fifty messages should produce ten to fifteen shops. Set each one up personally. This takes half an hour a day and no money at all.
HALF AN HOUR A DAY, FOR TWO WEEKS
-

One test, and it is not sign-ups

Sign-ups are not the test. Nor are compliments, or people saying it looks good. Those cost nothing to give.



Five of these by end of November

The idea works. The job is to do more of exactly the same thing.

A hundred and fifty asked, and none

The problem is who is being asked, or what they are offered. Still not a reason to build more.

Only the black box counts. The three hollow boxes before it can all happen and still leave the business exactly where it started.

WHY THIS TEST AND NO OTHER

Everything before the last box has already been proven — the software works, and it has been checked thousands of times over. What has never once happened is money reaching a Ghanaian seller through it. Until that has been seen, nothing else is evidence of anything.

Where these facts come from. What was built, what the software charges, and what it does with the money were read straight out of the software and can be checked by anyone. The state of the live website, the open document and the message failures come from project notes — confirm those before repeating them outside. What Paystack charges and what the law requires are not in the software and must be asked of those two parties. Sales figures illustrating the fee are examples, not measurements: no shop has sold anything yet.